

# **Case Study**

## **UPI/Online Payment Fraud**

UPI/Online Payment Fraud is one of the most common cybercrimes in today's world , especially among students and working professionals. It usually begins with a scammer contacting the victim through a phone call, message, or social media. The scammer may pretend to be a bank representative, a buyer, or a customer care executive.

In a typical scenario, the fraudster tells the victim that they need to "receive money" and asks them to scan a QR code or click on a link. The victim is then guided to enter their UPI PIN, believing it is required to receive funds. However, instead of receiving money, the amount gets deducted from their account. Sometimes, scammers also send fake payment screenshots to gain trust of the victim .

The main targets are people who are not fully aware of how UPI works, including elderly individuals and students new to digital payments.

The consequences can be serious, including financial loss, stress, and loss of trust in online systems. In some cases, victims may not be able to recover their money.

This situation could be avoided if users remember that receiving money does not require entering a UPI PIN. Awareness, careful verification, and avoiding unknown links or QR codes can significantly reduce the risk of such fraud.